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INTERNSHIP REPORT

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ABSTRACT

You probably have to follow the structure of this first paragraph.

The thesis titled **Fission in the Frontend: Building a Nuclear Reactor in JavaScript** was developed by student LastName FirstName as a bachelor's project at the Technical University of Moldova. It is written in English and contains an introduction, 4 chapters (Domain Analysis, Requirements Specification, System Design, System Implementation), a list of figures, a list of tables, conclusion, bibliography, and appendices.

Keywords: JavaScript, nuclear reactor, frontend engineering, asynchronous meltdown, satire

In this groundbreaking study, we explore the totally safe and not-at-all terrifying proposition of building and operating a fully functional nuclear reactor system entirely in JavaScript. Historically relegated to the humble browser and the occasional web app that crashes if you press Backspace too hard, JavaScript is the ideal language for controlling a high-risk, high-complexity critical infrastructure system like a nuclear power plant. Leveraging cutting-edge technologies like `setTimeout()`, `localStorage`, and a loosely defined global state, we demonstrate how a single-page web app can reach critical mass—both figuratively and literally. With asynchronous core cooling (using Promises), CSS-based hazard lights, and a Node.js-powered Geiger counter API (because why not), our system boasts at least 60% uptime and 40% existential dread. This paper is a satirical ode to the modern web stack and its uncanny ability to appear everywhere it absolutely should not.

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INTRODUCTION

Changes in technology continue to alter possibilities for learning and create new challenges for pedagogy. Over the last two decades, colleges and universities adapted and responded to the Internet, email, chat, and instant messaging, course management software, podcasts, personal digital assistants (PDAs), and much more. The growing use of mobile technology at colleges and universities is the most current trend forcing educators to evaluate the merits and limitations of new technology. The Internet is particularly among students 12–25-years. Further, web technology figures prominently in the future of higher education, particularly in its integration into teaching and learning. This project is an web application used to help both teachers, students for communication, searching and exchanging information on any topic, from hobbies to news, offering users the opportunity to join thematic channels to discuss content and find solutions to their problems.

1 DOMAIN ANALYSIS

Lack of centralized platform which gives student opportunity to post their thought and question, coupled with the limitations of the end-of-semester SIMU feedback system, restricts timely academic improvements and leaves prospective students with insufficient authentic information about university life.

1.1 Problem Definition

In Moldova, there is a significant gap in platforms that enable students to communicate, share knowledge, and exchange experiences, unlike in other countries where such platforms are common. The primary mechanism for student feedback, the end-of-semester evaluation platform (SIMU), is limited to collecting feedback once per semester without facilitating interaction or discussion among students. This restricts timely improvements to the academic experience. Additionally, students perceive a lack of anonymity in SIMU, fearing academic reprisal, which discourages honest and constructive feedback. Furthermore, prospective students rely on curated university marketing materials and anecdotal stories, which fail to provide authentic insights into daily student life, leaving critical questions about courses and campus experiences unanswered. A solution is needed to create a platform that fosters continuous, anonymous, and transparent communication and knowledge-sharing among students, enhancing the academic environment and providing reliable information for prospective students.

- **Infrequent Feedback Collection:** The SIMU platform collects feedback only once per semester, at its conclusion. This timing prevents instructors and administrators from implementing timely changes to address student concerns, rendering the feedback ineffective for improving the ongoing academic experience.
- **Perceived Lack of Anonymity:** Despite assurances of anonymity, many students fear that their critical feedback could be traced back to them. This apprehension, stemming from concerns about potential academic reprisal from professors, discourages honest and constructive criticism, undermining the quality and candor of the feedback provided.
- **Limited Information for Prospective Students:** Their primary sources are official marketing materials and anecdotal stories. While helpful, marketing content is designed to present the university in the best possible light and often fails to capture the day-to-day realities of student life. This leaves critical questions unanswered about course difficulty, professor teaching styles, campus culture, and the true student routine.

To address these challenges, our proposed solution, the Student Forum application, aims to provide a platform that facilitates continuous, anonymous, and transparent feedback from students. This platform will

empower students to share honest insights and experiences in real time, fostering a more responsive academic environment and providing prospective students with a clearer, more authentic picture of university life.

1.2 Problem Analysis

To better understand the challenges students face and to validate the need for a dedicated communication and feedback platform, we conducted a survey with university students across different years of study. The survey explored frustrations during the semester, feedback practices, access to information, and communication habits.

Frustrations During Semester:

Students most frequently reported difficulties with managing schedules and deadlines, finding reliable study partners, and organizing group projects. These frustrations highlight the need for a structured tool that simplifies coordination and improves access to peer support.

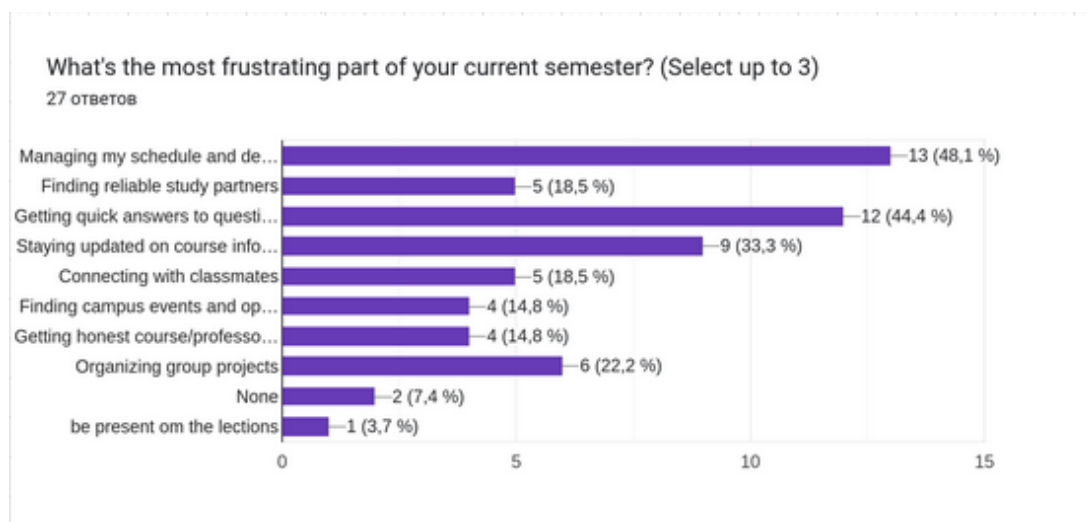


Figure 1.1 - Most Frustrating Aspects of Current Semester

As shown in Figure 1.1, managing schedules and deadlines (48.1%) emerged as the primary concern, followed by finding reliable study partners (18.5%) and getting quick answers to questions (44.4%). These statistics reinforce the need for a centralized platform that addresses these specific pain points.

Importance of Knowing Professors:

On a scale from 1 (not important) to 5 (very important), students rated an average of around 4, indicating that knowledge about professors' teaching styles significantly influences their academic choices. However, most information is currently gathered informally through word of mouth or social media, showing the lack of an official and transparent source.

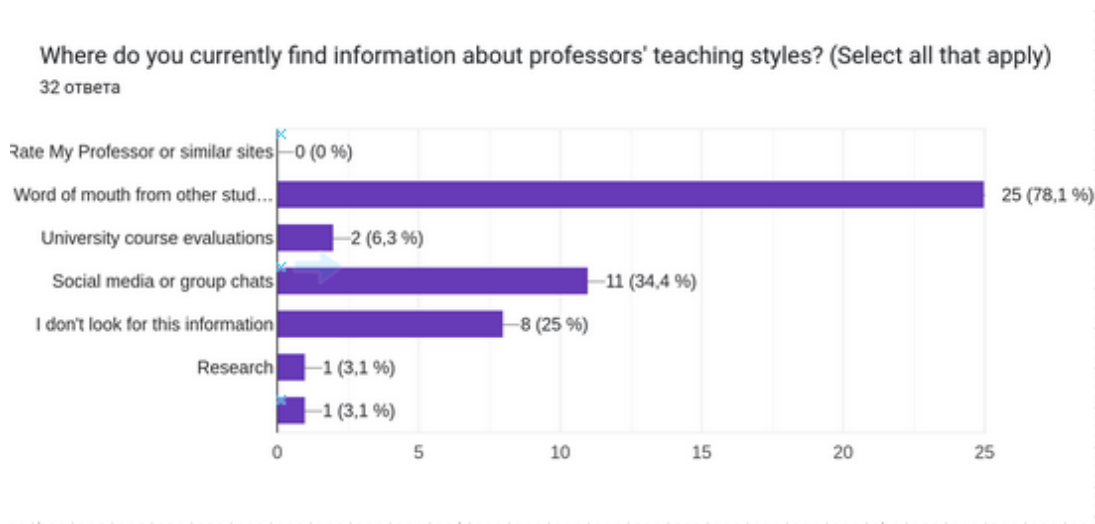


Figure 1.2 - Sources of Information About Professors' Teaching Styles

As shown in Figure 1.2, word of mouth from other students (78.1%) is the predominant source of information about professors, followed by social media or group chats (34.4%). Notably, only 6.3% of students use official university course evaluations, highlighting the need for a more formalized and accessible platform for sharing this information.

Barriers to Asking Questions:

A large portion of respondents cited fear of seeming unprepared, discomfort in speaking up, or not wanting to waste others' time as reasons for avoiding questions in class or office hours. This demonstrates the need for anonymous channels of communication where students can seek help without judgment.

Finding Academic Support:

Students typically identify helpful classmates by observing participation in class or asking around randomly. This inefficient process shows potential for a platform that makes peer expertise and study partnerships more visible and accessible.

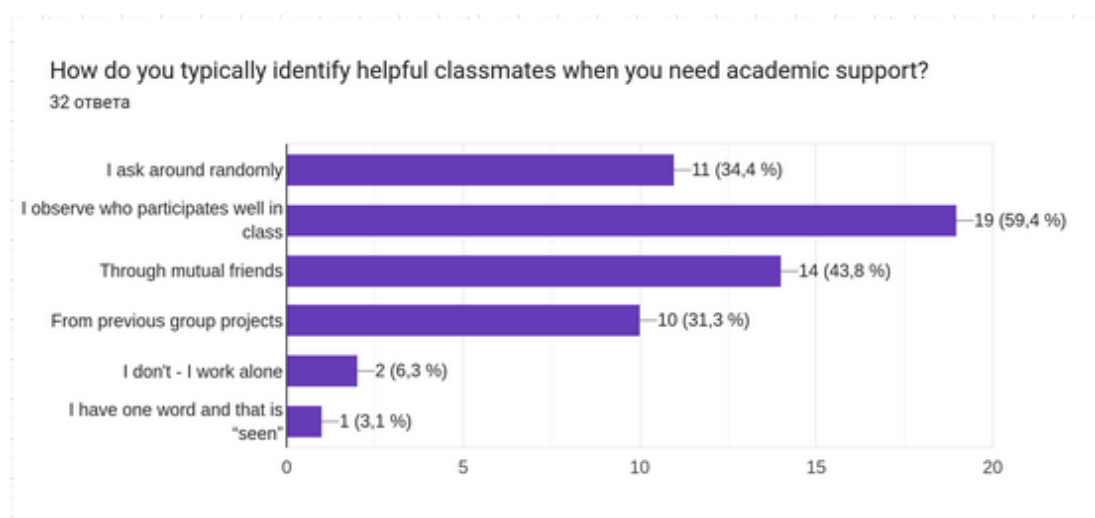


Figure 1.3 - Survey Results: Methods of Identifying Academic Support Partners

As shown in Figure 1.3, classroom participation observation (59.4%) is the primary method students use to identify potential study partners, followed by connecting through mutual friends (43.8%) and random asking (34.4%). Previous group project experience (31.3%) also plays a significant role. Only 6.3% of students prefer to work alone, indicating a strong need for collaborative learning support.

Communication and Coordination:

Most students rely on messaging apps and word of mouth to communicate with peers, but these are fragmented and lack academic focus. Additionally, students reported frequently missing important announcements or struggling to coordinate decisions like meeting times, further reinforcing the need for a centralized forum.

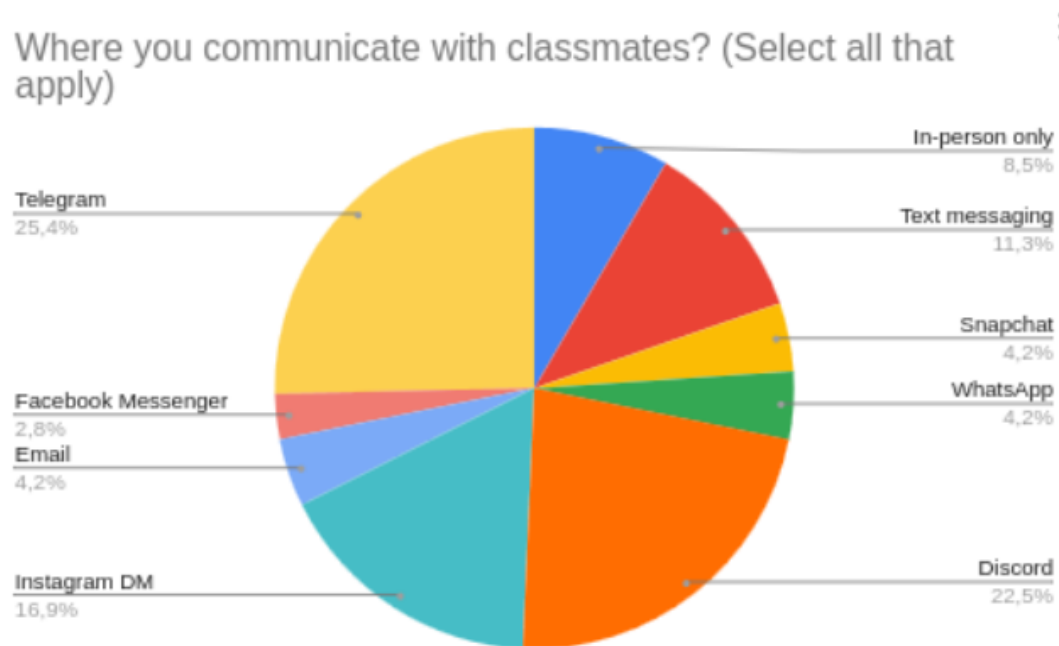


Figure 1.4 - Primary Communication Channels Among Students

As shown in Figure, Discord emerged as the primary communication platform, followed closely by Facebook Messenger and text messaging. Email remains relevant for formal communications, while platforms like Telegram and Instagram DMs are used by a smaller percentage of students. Notably, in-person communication accounts for only about 11.3% of interactions, highlighting the strong preference for digital communication methods among modern students.

Satisfaction with Current Tools:

When asked to rate satisfaction with existing tools on a scale from 1 to 10, the average rating was low to moderate, signaling clear room for improvement in digital platforms tailored to student needs.

Campus Events and Study Groups Discovery:

The survey investigated how students discover and stay informed about campus activities and study opportunities. Results show a diverse mix of both digital and traditional information channels.

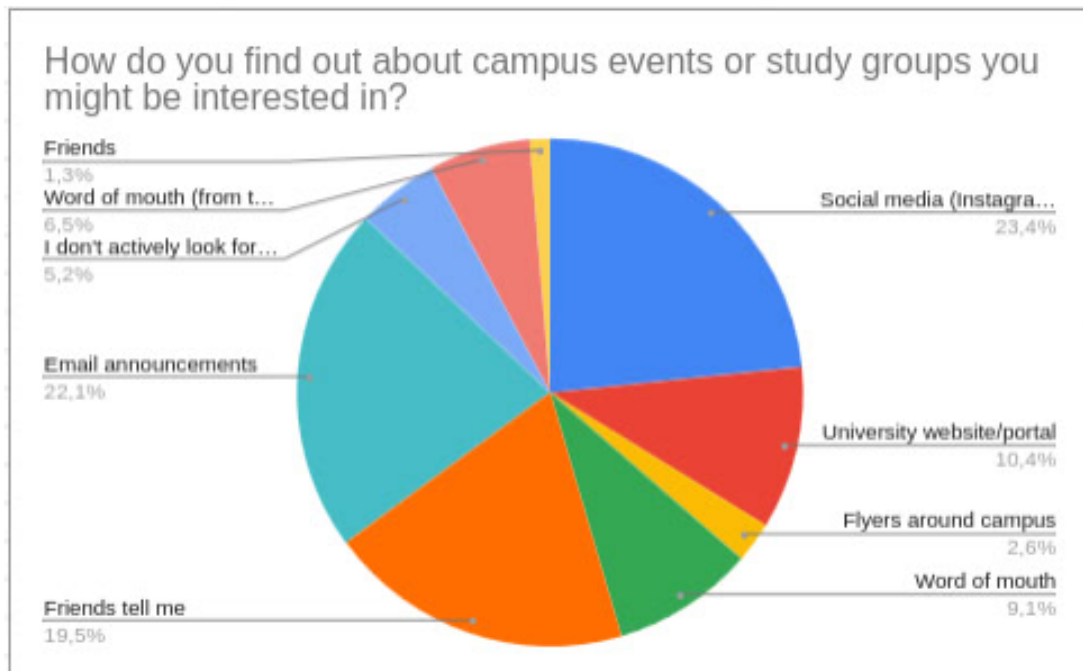


Figure 1.5 - Survey Results: Sources for Campus Events and Study Groups Information

Social media platforms (23.4%) represent the primary source for discovering campus events and study groups, followed closely by the university website/portal (22.1%). Email announcements (22.1%) maintain significant relevance, while traditional methods like flyers around campus (9.1%) and word of mouth (9.1%) still play a role. Notably, 5.2% of students report not actively seeking such information, suggesting a potential gap in engagement that could be addressed through a more centralized and accessible platform.

The survey confirms that students face recurring issues with communication, feedback, and access to reliable academic information. Current solutions are fragmented, informal, and often discourage participation due to lack of anonymity. A dedicated platform would address these gaps by enabling continuous, transparent, and anonymous communication, ultimately improving the academic environment and empowering students with authentic insights.

1.3 Solution Proposal

Based on the survey results and identified challenges, we propose the development of a **Student Forum Platform**. This solution directly addresses the needs of both prospective and currently enrolled students by providing a centralized, anonymous, and transparent space for communication, feedback, and knowledge-sharing. The following arguments illustrate the necessity and impact of this platform.

1.3.1 Argument I: A Platform for Prospective Students

The Problem. Prospective students are often forced to make one of the most important decisions of their lives—choosing a university—based on limited and idealized sources of information. Their primary references are official marketing materials and anecdotal stories. While helpful, these materials are curated to present the university in the best light and rarely capture the realities of daily student life. As a result, important questions regarding course difficulty, professors’ teaching styles, campus culture, and the overall student experience remain unanswered.

The Consequence. This lack of authentic information creates uncertainty and hesitation. Prospective students who cannot find genuine, peer-to-peer answers to their concerns may feel less confident in their choice and may opt for other institutions that appear more transparent and relatable.

Our Solution. The forum will offer a dedicated, searchable space where prospective students can directly ask questions to the university community. Current students can share their genuine experiences, providing an unfiltered perspective on courses, professors, and campus life. This peer-to-peer interaction creates a trusted and transparent resource, empowering prospective students to make more informed decisions and increasing the likelihood of their enrollment.

1.3.2 Argument II: A Platform Where Enrolled Students Are Heard

The Problem. For enrolled students, satisfaction and belonging are critical to their academic success and retention. However, the existing feedback system is inadequate. The current mechanism, the SIMU platform, suffers from two major limitations: Feedback is collected only once at the end of the semester, when it is too late to implement meaningful improvements. Despite assurances, many students believe their feedback is not truly anonymous. This fear of academic reprisal discourages open and constructive criticism.

The Consequence. This flawed feedback system creates an environment where students feel powerless and unheard. Unresolved concerns about teaching quality, course design, and administrative practices accumulate over time, leading to frustration, disengagement, and in some cases, student attrition.

Our Solution. The proposed forum provides a continuous, community-driven dialogue space where students can openly discuss academic and administrative issues in real time. Anonymous participation ensures that students feel safe sharing candid feedback without fear of reprisal. Beyond individual expression, the platform fosters collaborative problem-solving, allowing the student body to collectively identify issues and propose solutions. This cultivates a stronger sense of agency, involvement, and ownership in the academic community.

By addressing the needs of both prospective and current students, the Student Forum platform cre-

ates a dual impact: it strengthens the university's reputation and attractiveness for future applicants while simultaneously enhancing the academic environment for those already enrolled. This solution fosters transparency, trust, and collaboration, ultimately contributing to a more supportive and dynamic university community.

Table 1.1 - SWOT Analysis

Strengths	Weaknesses	Opportunities	Threats
Most comprehensive features set	Resource - Intensive	Potential Partnerships	Resistance to change from other social media
Flexible group/channels system	Limited Accessibility of user accounts from university	Feedback and improvement in real time	Competing Solutions
Freendly UI	No anonymity features	University community chat	Connect all university in one app
University multiple content type	Privacy content	Ditch the teacher for better learning	Motivate people to use our app

1.4 Target Group

The target audience includes two different groups:

Students: Students are the primary target group. They are involved in following aspects: Undergraduate and graduate students seeking academic support. Students looking for study groups and project collaborators. Those wanting to share experiences about courses and professors. Students seeking real-time feedback and answers to academic questions

Potential Students: High school graduates researching university programs. Transfer students evaluating the university environment. International students seeking authentic insights into campus life. Individuals exploring specific course experiences and requirements

1.5 Existing Solutions

The landscape of student-focused social platforms has evolved significantly in recent years, driven by changing communication preferences and the increasing digitization of academic communities. This comprehensive analysis examines four distinct platforms that serve various aspects of student social interaction and community building. The platforms under consideration include the berkslv social media application, GoIn Connect's pre-enrollment community platform, Jodel's anonymous hyperlocal network, and the proposed student forum solution designed with Reddit-like functionality.

Each platform addresses unique market segments within the broader student community ecosystem.

The berkslv application focuses on verified Turkish university students through institutional email verification, creating a trusted regional community. GoIn Connect operates in the pre-enrollment space, facilitating connections between admitted students before they arrive at universities, with a business-to-business model targeting educational institutions. Jodel provides anonymous, location-based social networking within a 10-kilometer radius, appealing to students who prefer privacy in their digital interactions. The proposed student forum aims to combine the familiar Reddit interface with student-specific features including channels, polls, and category-based organization.

The analysis reveals significant opportunities in the market for a platform that can effectively combine the strengths of existing solutions while addressing their limitations. The proposed student forum platform has the potential to occupy a unique position in the market through its comprehensive feature set and focus on long-term academic community building rather than ephemeral social interactions.

1.6 Platform Functionality and Core Purpose

1.6.1 berkslv Social Media Application

The berkslv social media application functions as a closed social network exclusively designed for Turkish university students. The platform operates on the principle of verified academic communities, requiring users to authenticate using official university email addresses ending with .edu.tr domains. This verification system ensures that all participants are legitimate members of Turkish higher education institutions, creating a trusted environment for academic and social discourse.

The application serves as a digital campus commons where Turkish students can share experiences, discuss academic matters, and build connections within their national higher education community. Users can create posts about university life, academic challenges, career opportunities, and social events relevant to the Turkish student experience. The platform facilitates connections between students from different universities across Turkey, enabling knowledge sharing and collaborative opportunities that might not otherwise occur.

The focus on Turkish higher education creates a culturally cohesive community where users share common educational experiences, language, and cultural references. This targeted approach allows for discussions that are highly relevant to the specific challenges and opportunities faced by students within the Turkish academic system, including topics such as YKS exam preparation, university transfer processes, and career prospects within the Turkish job market.

1.6.2 GoIn Connect Platform

GoIn Connect operates as a pre-arrival community platform specifically designed to connect admitted students before they begin their university studies. The platform addresses the critical transition period

between acceptance and enrollment, when prospective students often experience anxiety about moving to new environments, making friends, and adapting to university life. The application creates cohort-based communities organized around specific university programs and entry periods.

The platform facilitates practical information sharing among incoming students, including housing arrangements, visa processes, travel planning, and academic preparation. Students use the platform to find potential roommates, organize group travel to campus, share tips about local amenities, and coordinate social meetings before official orientation programs begin. The application serves as an informal orientation system that operates independently of official university programs.

GoIn Connect functions as a social safety net for international and domestic students who may feel isolated or uncertain about their upcoming university experience. The platform enables students to build support networks and friendships before arriving on campus, reducing the social and emotional challenges associated with starting university life. Universities partner with GoIn Connect to improve student satisfaction, reduce dropout rates, and enhance the overall student experience from the moment of admission.

1.6.3 Jodel Anonymous Network

Jodel operates as a hyperlocal, anonymous social network that connects users within a 10-kilometer geographic radius without revealing their identities. The platform functions as a digital neighborhood bulletin board where users can share thoughts, ask questions, seek advice, and engage in discussions with others in their immediate vicinity. The complete anonymity removes social barriers and allows for more authentic communication about sensitive or personal topics.

The application serves multiple community functions including local information sharing, event announcements, buy-and-sell transactions, and social commentary about neighborhood or campus happenings. Students particularly use Jodel to discuss university-related topics without fear of academic or social repercussions, share honest opinions about courses and professors, and seek help with academic or personal challenges while maintaining privacy.

The voting system allows the community to self-moderate content, with popular posts gaining visibility while inappropriate or irrelevant content becomes less prominent. This democratic approach to content curation creates communities that reflect the collective interests and values of local user populations. The temporal nature of content, combined with geographic boundaries, creates dynamic local conversations that remain relevant to immediate community concerns.

1.7 Feature Comparison and Functionality Analysis

The functional capabilities of each platform reflect their distinct positioning and target audience requirements. Traditional social media features form the foundation of most platforms, but specialized

functionality differentiates each offering in significant ways.

User authentication mechanisms vary considerably across platforms, reflecting different priorities regarding user verification and privacy. The berkslv application requires university email verification, creating a trusted community environment but potentially excluding users who prefer privacy or lack current university affiliation. GoIn Connect uses invitation-based authentication through university partnerships, ensuring users belong to specific cohorts while maintaining some level of identity verification.

Jodel's completely anonymous approach eliminates traditional authentication requirements, allowing users to participate without revealing personal information. This approach reduces barriers to participation but creates challenges for community management and abuse prevention. The proposed student forum includes standard login functionality but has not specified whether additional verification mechanisms would be implemented.

Content creation capabilities demonstrate the platforms' different approaches to user engagement. The berkslv application supports traditional social media posts with standard commenting functionality, providing familiar interaction patterns for users. GoIn Connect facilitates community-focused content sharing with emphasis on practical information exchange and social connection building among incoming students.

Jodel's content model centers on short, anonymous posts called "jodels" within geographic boundaries, creating spontaneous local conversations. The voting mechanism allows community-driven content curation without requiring user identification. The proposed student forum incorporates more sophisticated content types including traditional posts, threaded comments, and dedicated polling functionality, suggesting a more comprehensive approach to student discourse.

Group and community organization features reveal fundamental differences in platform philosophy. The berkslv application appears to rely on broader community interaction without specific group segmentation features. GoIn Connect creates cohort-based communities organized around university programs and entry periods, facilitating relevant connections among students with shared experiences and timelines.

Jodel's location-based model creates implicit communities within geographic boundaries without formal group structures. Users within the same area automatically share a common posting space, creating organic local communities. The proposed student forum incorporates explicit channel and category systems, allowing users to organize discussions around specific topics, courses, or interests with greater granularity than other platforms provide.

Table 1.2 - Comprehensive Platform Feature Comparison

Feature Category	berkslv App	GoIn Connect	Jodel	Student Forum
Authentication	University email required	Invitation-based	Anonymous only	MFA with corporate email
Content Types	Traditional posts	Community updates	Anonymous jodels	Posts, polls, comments
Interaction Model	Standard comments	Community chat	Anonymous replies	Threaded discussions
Search Functionality	Not implemented	Limited	Location-focused	Comprehensive planned
Voting/Polls	Not available	Not available	Post voting	Dedicated poll system
Geographic Scope	Turkey only	Global partnerships	Multi-country	UTM
Target Users	Turkish students	Pre-enrolled students	Local communities	General students and potential UTM users

Overview

The analysis examines: The Four Platforms:

berkslv's Social Media App - A Turkish university-focused platform with email verification
 GoIn Connect - A pre-enrollment community platform for university partnerships
 Jodel - An anonymous, hyperlocal social network popular with students
 Our Student Forum - The proposed Helper discussion platform

Key Insights: Market Positioning: Your forum sits in a unique space with high functionality but needs stronger differentiation. The current competitive landscape shows:

Jodel dominates anonymous local communication
 GoIn Connect owns the pre-enrollment market through university partnerships
 berkslv's app serves the verified regional community need
 Our forum has the most comprehensive feature set but lacks a clear unique selling proposition

2 SYSTEM DESIGN

2.1 System Requirements

2.1.1 Functional Requirements

The student forum application implements the following core functional capabilities:

User Management

- **FR-1:** User registration with email verification - The system shall allow new users to create accounts by providing email, username, and password credentials, followed by mandatory email verification before account activation.
- **FR-2:** Secure user authentication - The system shall authenticate users through secure login mechanisms using Supabase authentication services with session-based state management.
- **FR-3:** Profile management - Users shall be able to view and update their profile information including personal details and forum preferences.
- **FR-4:** Session management - The system shall maintain user sessions securely with automatic timeout and proper session invalidation upon logout.

Content Management

- **FR-5:** Multi-type post creation - Authenticated users shall be able to create, edit, and delete three types of forum posts: basic text posts, interactive polls with multiple options, and event posts with date/time and location information.
- **FR-6:** Comment system - Users shall be able to add, edit, and delete comments on forum posts with proper threading and moderation capabilities.
- **FR-7:** Content search - The system shall provide advanced search functionality to locate posts and comments based on keywords, filters, and content type with real-time suggestions.
- **FR-8:** Channel management system - The system shall organize posts into channels with approval workflows, channel categories (general, academic, social, announcements), and speciality-specific channels for targeted discussions.
- **FR-15:** Post interaction system - Users shall be able to upvote and downvote posts and comments to promote quality content and community-driven content curation.
- **FR-16:** Student verification system - The system shall verify student status through university email verification and student card validation (pending approval process) to distinguish verified students from general users.

Academic Services

- **FR-17:** Course review system - Verified students shall be able to review courses per speciality with ratings and written feedback to help fellow students make informed academic decisions.
- **FR-18:** Professor search and evaluation - The system shall provide a searchable database of professors with aggregated ratings, reviews, and course associations for academic planning.

Future Features (Planned)

- **FR-19:** Location-based channels - The system shall support local channels that display posts based on geographic proximity to enhance campus-specific discussions (future implementation).
- **FR-20:** Personal schedule integration - Users shall be able to import and manage personal calendars with course schedules and event integration (future implementation).

Security and Access Control

- **FR-9:** Role-based access control - The system shall implement three user roles: verified students (university email verification), unverified users (limited access), and admin users, with appropriate permissions for content management and administrative functions.
- **FR-10:** Input validation and sanitization - All user inputs shall be validated server-side and sanitized to prevent injection attacks and ensure data integrity.
- **FR-11:** Secure API endpoints - All API routes shall require proper authentication and authorization before processing requests.
- **FR-12:** Professor and student rating system with leaderboards - Verified students shall be able to rate professors across multiple categories (teaching quality, communication, helpfulness) and rate fellow students in categories (academic help, collaboration, leadership, social), with anonymous review capabilities and leaderboard displays based on ratings.
- **FR-13:** Content recommendation system - The system shall provide intelligent content recommendations to users based on their academic speciality, interaction history, and channel preferences to enhance content discovery and engagement.
- **FR-14:** Audit logging - The system shall log user activities and security events for monitoring and compliance purposes.

2.1.2 Non-Functional Requirements

The application addresses critical security and performance requirements essential for a secure educational platform:

Security Requirements

- **NFR-1:** Encryption standards - All data transmission shall be encrypted using TLS 1.3, and sensitive data at rest shall be encrypted using AES-256 encryption algorithms.
- **NFR-2:** Password security - User passwords shall be hashed using bcrypt with a minimum of 12 salt rounds, and password policies shall enforce strong password requirements.
- **NFR-3:** Cross-Site Scripting (XSS) prevention - The application shall implement Content Security Policy (CSP) headers and input sanitization to prevent XSS attacks.
- **NFR-4:** Cross-Site Request Forgery (CSRF) protection - All state-changing operations shall be protected with anti-CSRF tokens and same-site cookie attributes.
- **NFR-5:** SQL injection prevention - Database operations shall use parameterized queries through Drizzle ORM to prevent SQL injection vulnerabilities.
- **NFR-6:** Session security - Sessions shall implement secure cookie attributes (HttpOnly, Secure, SameSite) with automatic timeout after 24 hours of inactivity.

Performance Requirements

- **NFR-7:** Response time - API endpoints shall respond within 500ms for 95% of requests under normal load conditions.
- **NFR-8:** Scalability - The system shall support concurrent access by up to 1000 authenticated users without performance degradation.
- **NFR-9:** Database performance - Database queries shall be optimized with proper indexing to maintain sub-100ms response times for common operations.

Reliability and Availability

- **NFR-10:** System availability - The application shall maintain 99.5% uptime during operational hours with automated failover capabilities.
- **NFR-11:** Data backup - User data and forum content shall be automatically backed up daily with point-in-time recovery capabilities.
- **NFR-12:** Error handling - The system shall implement comprehensive error handling that prevents sensitive information disclosure while providing meaningful feedback to users.

Compliance and Standards

- **NFR-13:** Security standards compliance - The application shall adhere to OWASP Top 10 security guidelines and implement security best practices throughout the development lifecycle.

- **NFR-14:** Data privacy - User data handling shall comply with educational privacy standards and implement proper data retention policies.
- **NFR-15:** Accessibility - The user interface shall meet WCAG 2.1 Level AA accessibility standards to ensure inclusive access for all users.

2.2 System Architecture Overview

The student forum application follows a modern web architecture pattern utilizing Next.js as the full-stack framework, Supabase for authentication and database services, and Drizzle ORM for type-safe database operations. The system employs a component-based design that separates concerns between the frontend presentation layer, server-side business logic, and data persistence layer.

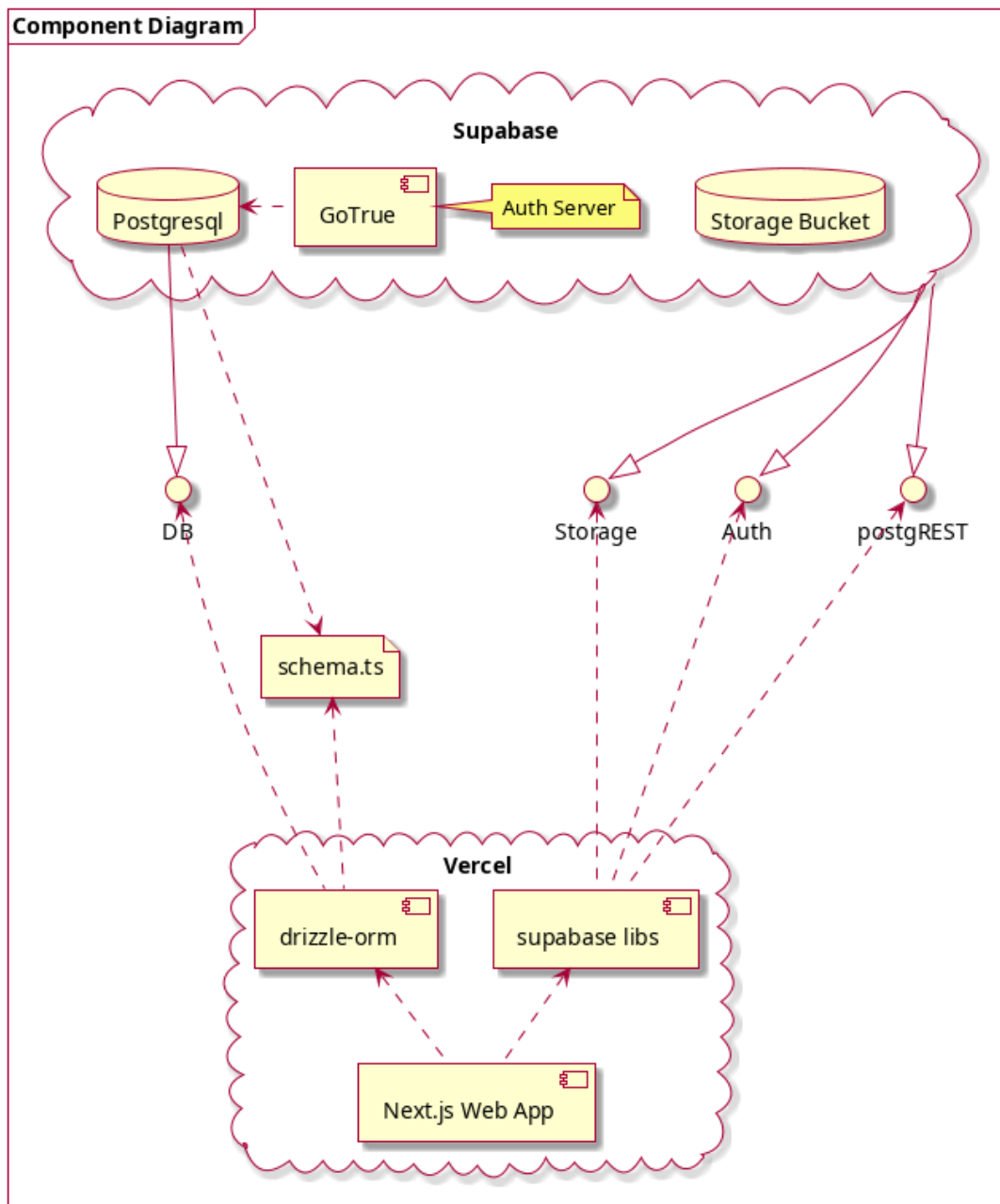


Figure 2.1 - System Component Architecture

The architecture shown in Figure 2.1 demonstrates the interaction between Vercel's hosting environment and Supabase's backend services. The Next.js application utilizes both Drizzle ORM for direct database operations and Supabase libraries for authentication and file storage, creating a hybrid approach that leverages the strengths of each technology.

2.3 Application Feature Design

The Next.js application follows a feature-based architecture where functionality is organized into distinct, modular components that interact through well-defined interfaces. This approach promotes code reusability, maintainability, and separation of concerns.

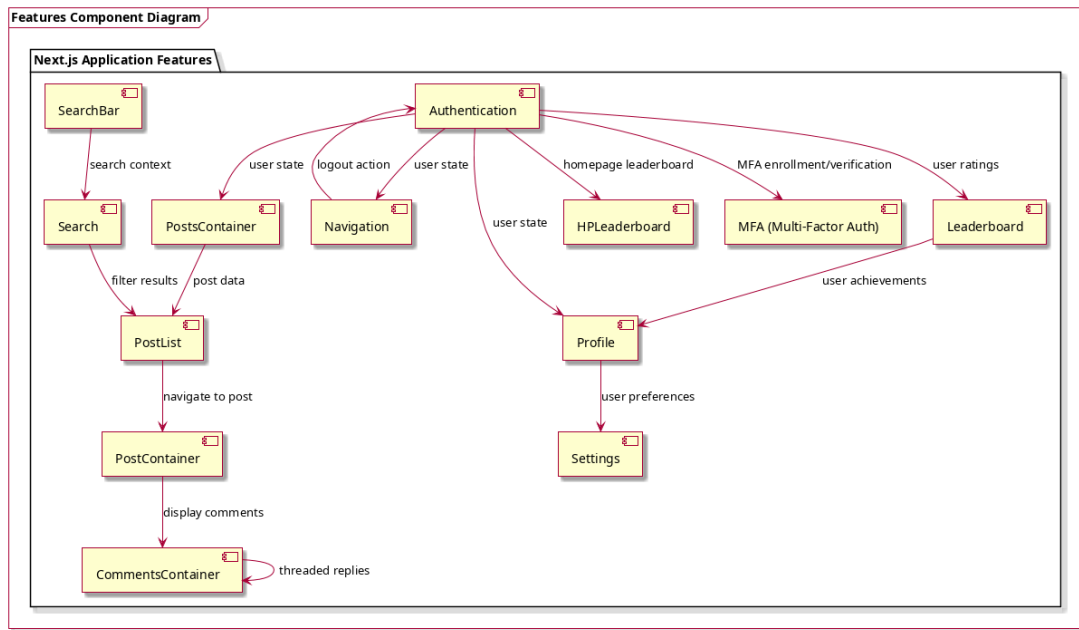


Figure 2.2 - Application Features Component Diagram

The feature architecture shown in Figure 2.2 demonstrates the modular design approach where each feature encapsulates its own components, actions, and types. The Authentication feature serves as the foundation, providing user state management that flows throughout the application. The PostsContainer and related components implement the core forum functionality with proper data flow and dependency management.

Key architectural principles implemented:

- **Separation of Concerns:** Each feature maintains its own actions, components, and types, preventing cross-feature dependencies and promoting modularity.
- **Data Flow Management:** User authentication state flows from the Authentication feature to dependent components, ensuring consistent user context throughout the application.
- **Component Reusability:** Generic UI components are shared across features while maintaining feature-specific business logic within dedicated modules.
- **State Management:** Centralized authentication state with distributed feature-specific state management for optimal performance and maintainability.

2.4 Data Model Design

The application employs a comprehensive relational database schema designed to support the complex relationships inherent in an academic forum platform. The schema encompasses user management, academic structure representation, content organization, and social interaction features while maintaining data integrity and security.

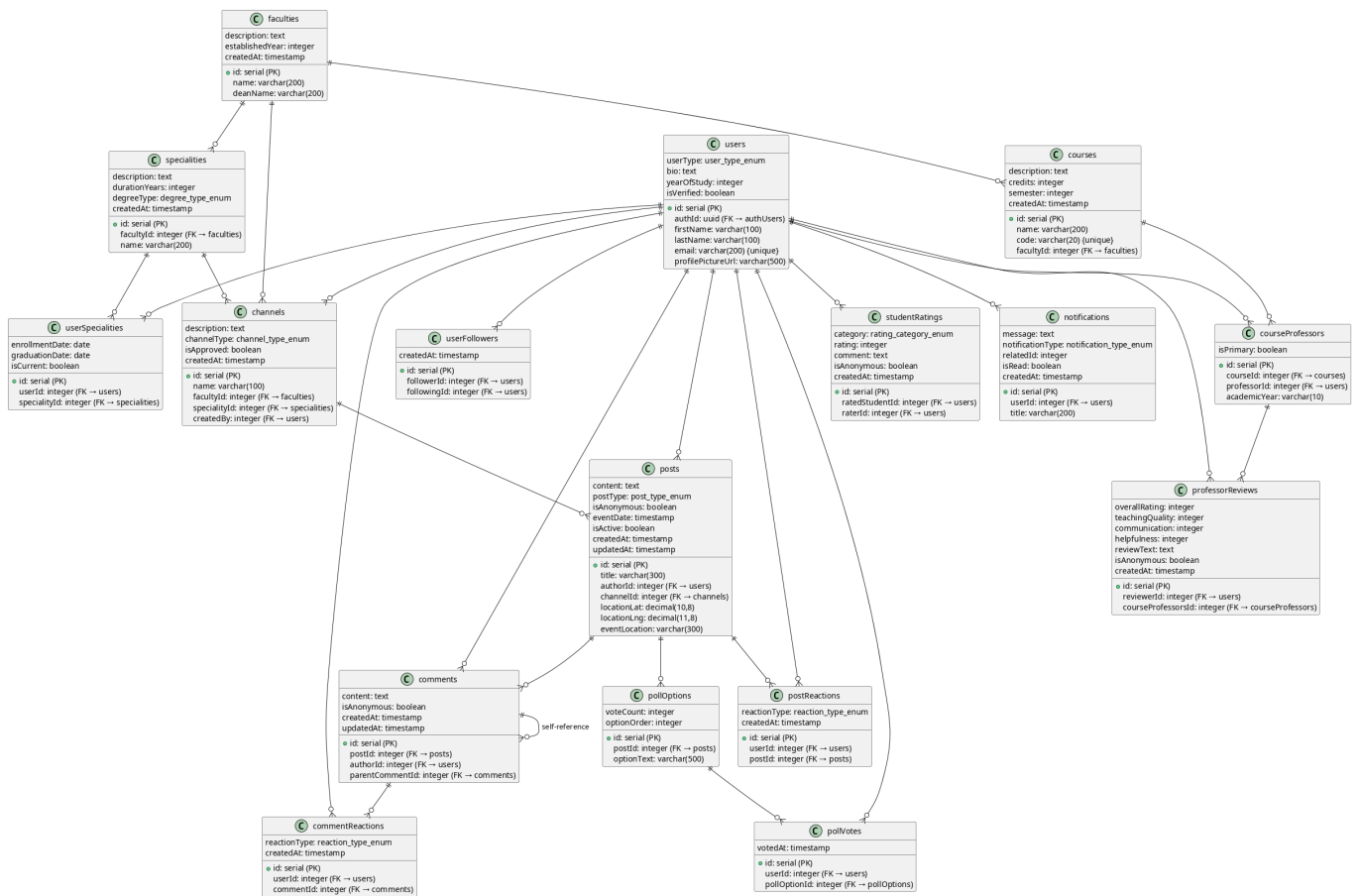


Figure 2.3 - Database Schema Class Diagram

Figure 2.3 illustrates the complete database structure with entities representing users, academic faculties and specialties, forum channels and posts, and various interaction mechanisms. The schema design emphasizes referential integrity through foreign key constraints and implements proper indexing strategies for optimal query performance.

The core entities include:

- **User Management:** Users table with authentication integration, supporting multiple user types (student, professor, admin) with profile information and verification status.
- **Academic Structure:** Faculties, specialties, and courses tables that model the university's organizational hierarchy with proper relationships and constraints.
- **Content System:** Posts, comments, and channels that facilitate forum discussions with support for anonymous posting, location-based content, and threaded conversations.
- **Interaction Features:** Reactions, ratings, polls, and social following mechanisms that enhance user engagement and content quality assessment.

2.5 Security Workflows

2.5.1 User Login Process

The login workflow implements a server-side action pattern that ensures secure authentication handling. When users submit their credentials, the system processes authentication through Supabase's secure authentication service while managing session cookies at the application level. The middleware layer automatically validates user sessions on subsequent requests, providing seamless protection for authenticated routes.

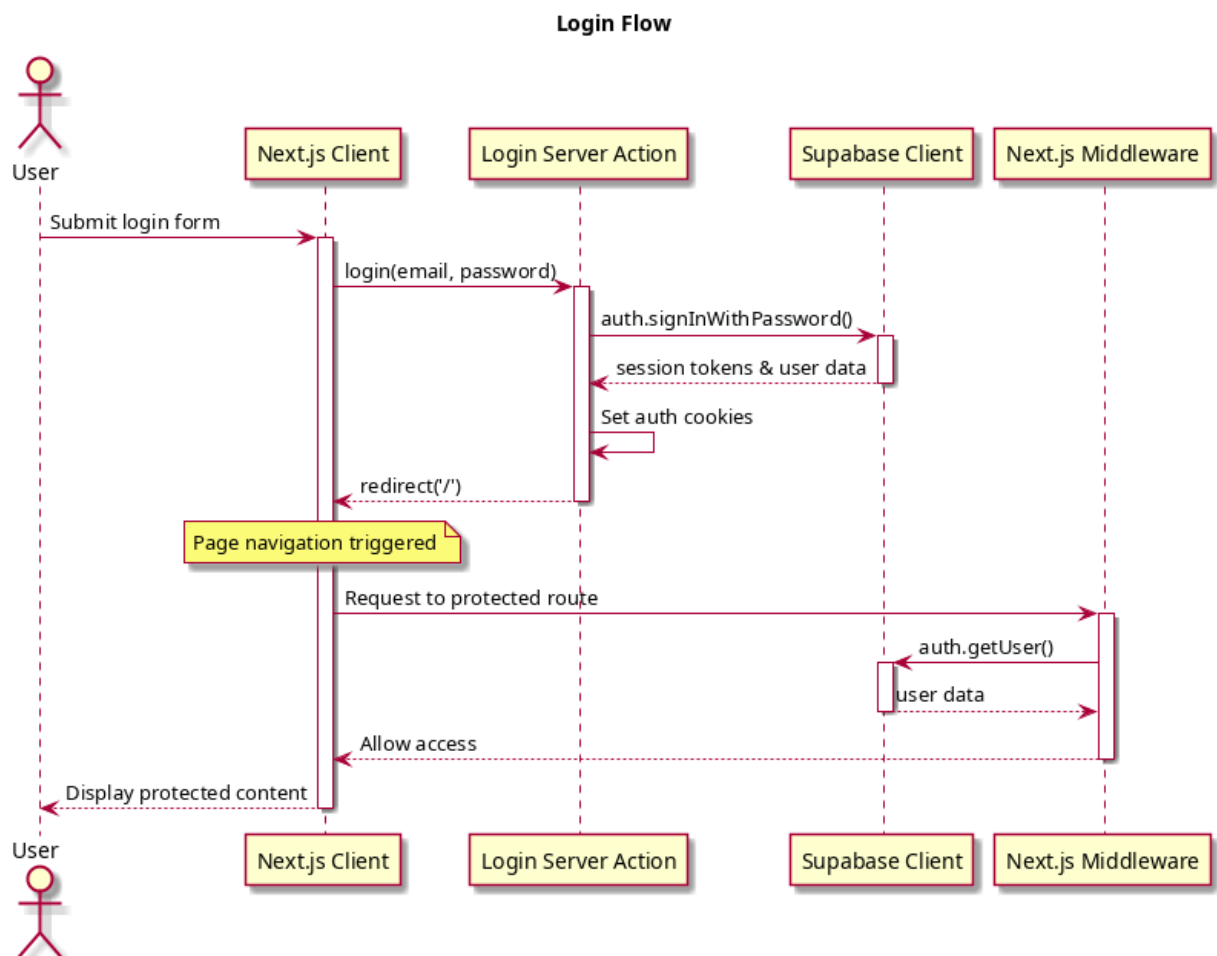


Figure 2.4 - User Login Sequence Flow

Figure 2.4 illustrates the complete login flow, from user credential submission through server-side validation and middleware-based route protection. The process ensures that authentication tokens are securely managed and automatically validated for protected resource access.

2.5.2 User Registration Process

The registration workflow incorporates both user profile creation and email verification processes. The system validates form data, checks for existing users in the database, and creates both authentication

records and user profile information atomically. Email confirmation is handled through Supabase's built-in email service, ensuring users verify their accounts before accessing protected features.

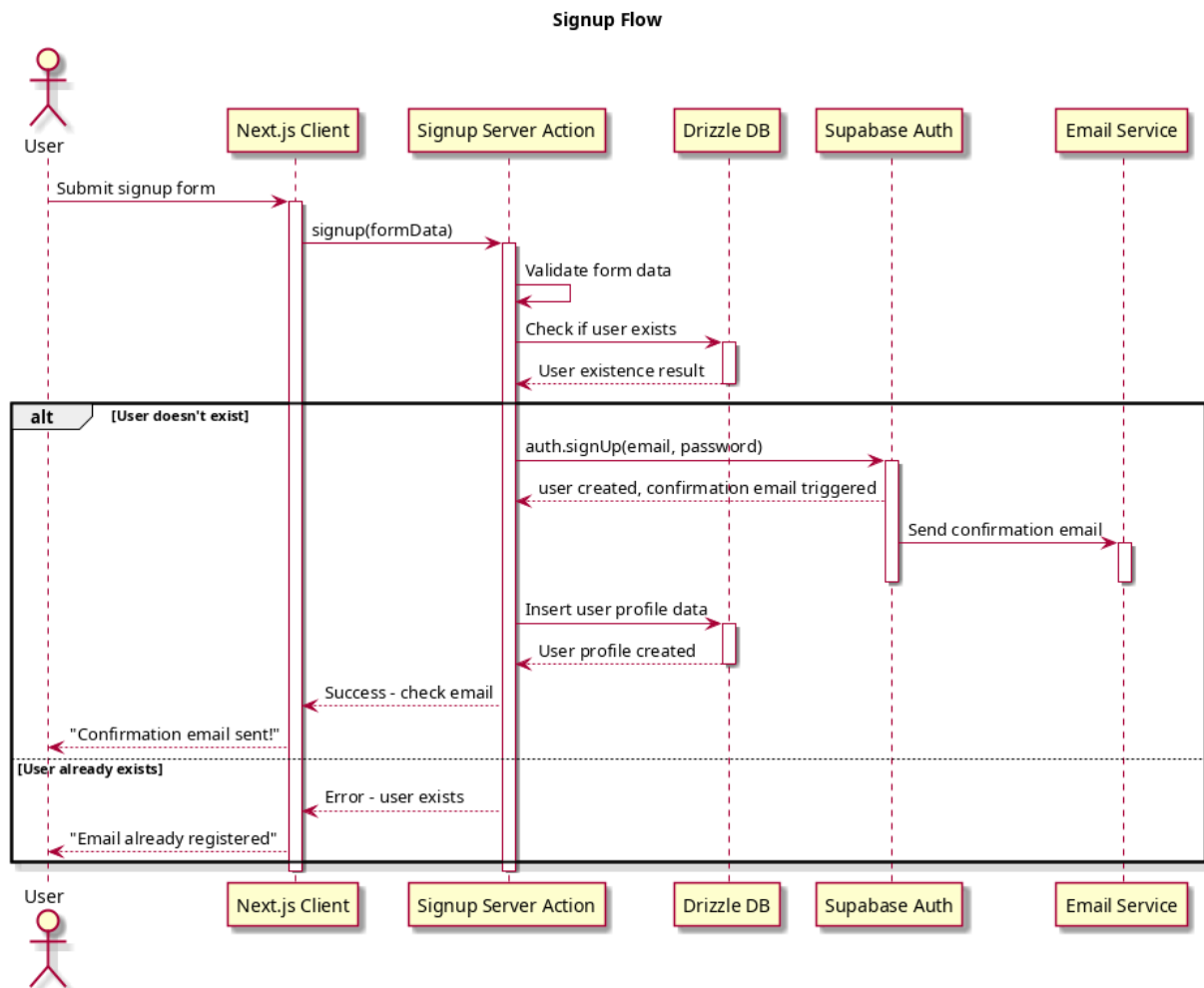


Figure 2.5 - User Registration Sequence Flow

The registration process shown in Figure 2.5 demonstrates the integration between form validation, database operations, and email confirmation services. The system maintains data consistency by performing all operations within a controlled transaction flow.

2.5.3 Email Confirmation Workflow

Email confirmation completes the user verification process through a secure callback mechanism. When users click the confirmation link, the application processes the verification code and establishes a verified user session. This workflow ensures that only users with verified email addresses can access the platform's full functionality.

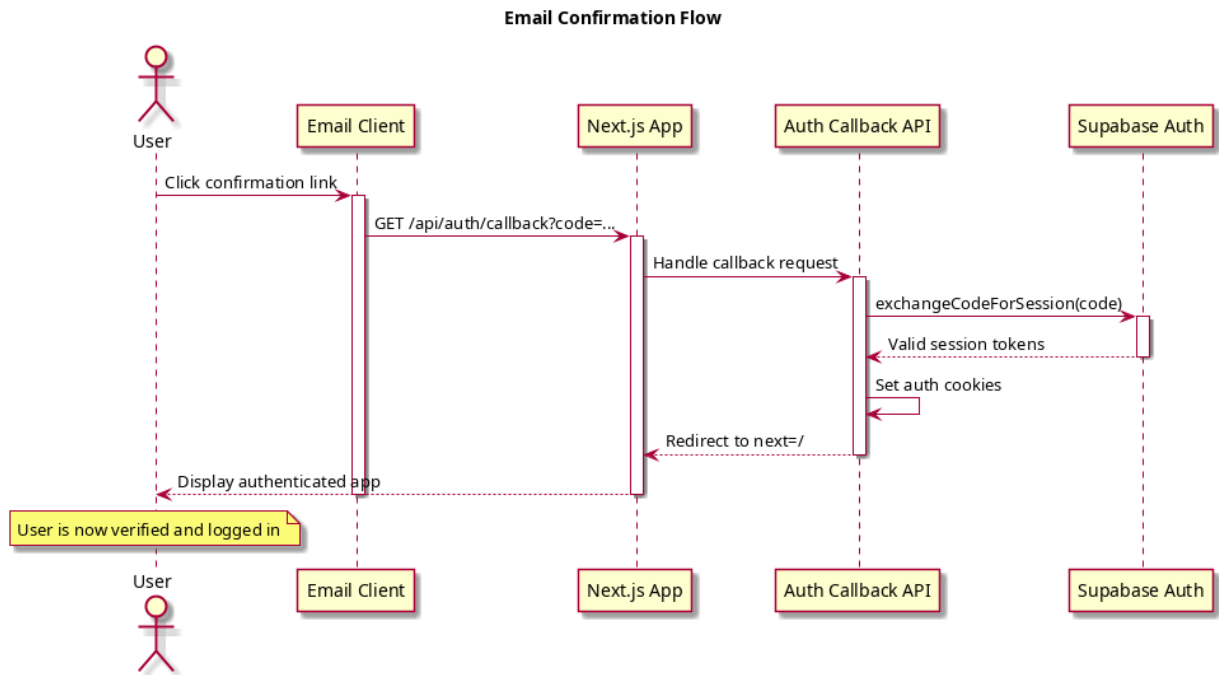


Figure 2.6 - Email Confirmation Sequence Flow

Figure 2.6 shows the secure token exchange process that validates user email addresses and establishes authenticated sessions. The callback API handles the verification seamlessly while maintaining security best practices.

2.5.4 Protected Route Access

The middleware-based protection system automatically validates user authentication status for all protected routes. This approach provides transparent security enforcement without requiring manual authentication checks in individual route handlers. The middleware evaluates user sessions and redirects unauthenticated users to the login page while allowing authenticated users to proceed normally.

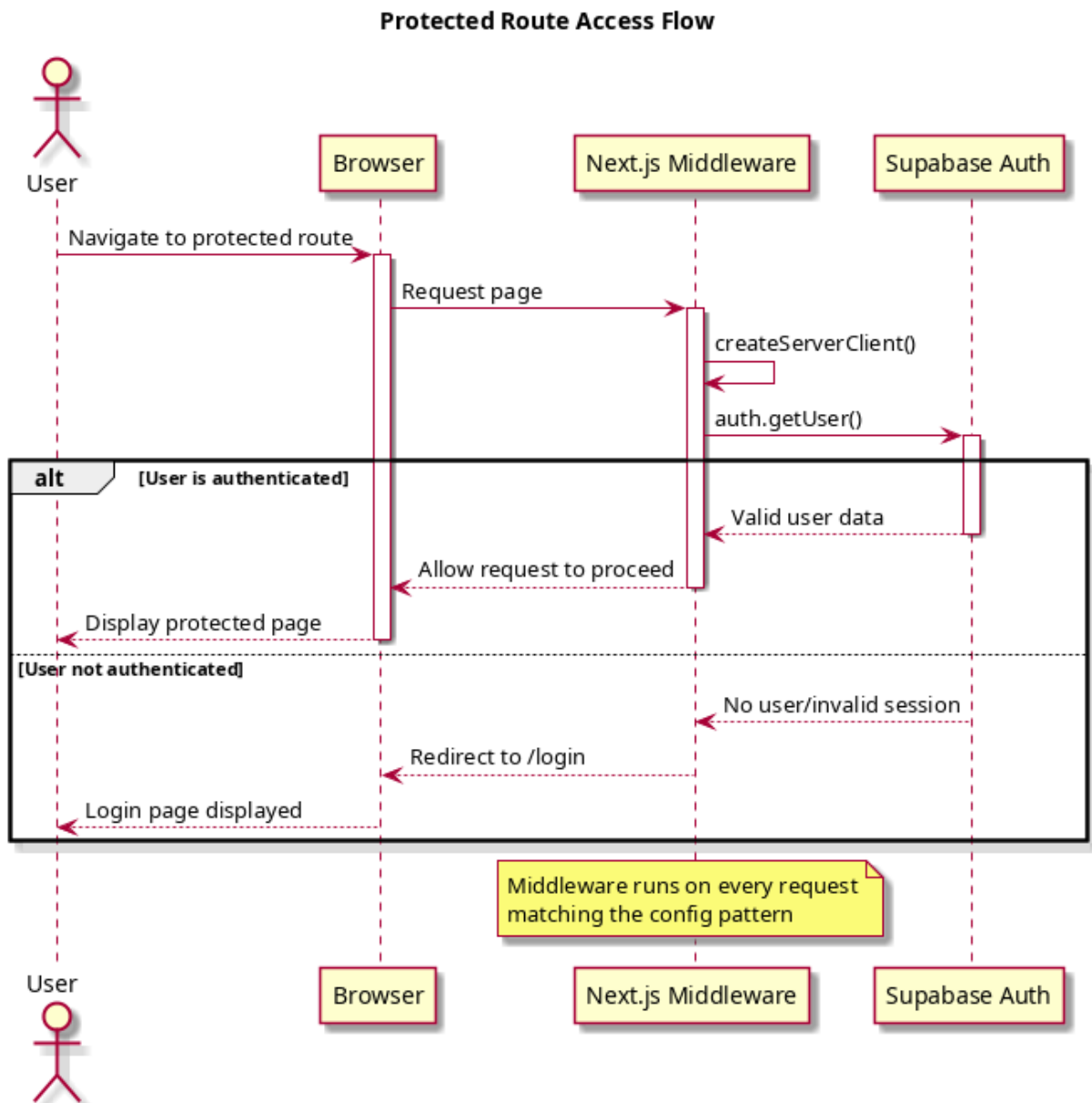


Figure 2.7 - Protected Route Access Sequence Flow

The protection mechanism illustrated in Figure 2.7 ensures consistent security enforcement across the application. The middleware pattern provides a centralized authentication checkpoint that automatically handles both authenticated and unauthenticated access scenarios.

3 SYSTEM IMPLEMENTATION

3.1 Authentication

Our project provides the user with an extensive range of possibilities for registering on the platform. The available options are:

1. Authentication with email and password
2. Additional MFA enrollment for two-factor authentication
3. Authentication using OAuth 2.0:
 - Google account
 - GitHub account (since we are software engineering students)
 - Azure/Microsoft account

Below we explain how each of these authentication methods works and which security measures are taken to mitigate possible attacks.

3.1.1 General authentication principle

The general principle of authentication is that information about the user's session is stored in cookies. The payload of these cookies is encrypted on the server. Cookies can contain the JWT access token and JWT refresh token in most cases, but additional cookies may also be set during the MFA process or OAuth authentication to keep track of the intermediate state of the user. For example, the user is not considered fully authenticated until they provide the TOTP code from their Authenticator app.

Cookies were chosen due to the following reasons:

- Extensive range of settings - unlike local storage, cookies provide more control through properties such as HttpOnly, Secure, and SameSite.
- Isolation from external scripts - by setting the HttpOnly property to true, we ensure that cookies can only be read on the server side of the application, preventing tampering with JavaScript. However, it is important to note that cookies can still be exploited by CSRF attacks.
- Automatic access on each request - cookies are sent with every request that matches their scope and policy. This makes it easy to verify whether the received cookies are still valid, and if not, to invalidate or update them.

3.1.2 Authentication with email and password

Here we describe how authentication with email works. When the user navigates to the `/register` path, they see a sign-up form where they must provide the following information:

1. Nickname
2. Email
3. Password
4. Profile picture

When the user clicks the *Register* button and the input is valid, they receive two things: an email with a confirmation link and a code verification cookie stored in their browser. This ensures that even if the confirmation link is leaked, it has no value without the cookie.

The confirmation link includes a token hash. When the user follows the link, both the token hash and the code verification cookie are sent to the authentication service, where their validity is checked. Once validated, the JWT access and refresh tokens are returned to the user in the form of encrypted cookies. At this point, the user is considered authenticated, and their identity can be confirmed on each request.

3.1.3 Setting up Multi-Factor Authentication

MFA enrollment

As an additional layer of security, we provide the option to use MFA. Each registered user can navigate to the `/settings/mfa-enroll` page to enroll in MFA authentication. They will see a call-to-action button; upon clicking it, a QR code and its equivalent setup key in plain text will be displayed. The user can scan the QR code with an Authenticator app (e.g., Google Authenticator or Microsoft Authenticator). After adding it, they must enter the newly generated code from the application into the input field below the setup key. If the code is correct, the user is considered enrolled.

MFA verification

When the user enters the correct email and password, they receive:

- A challenge ID - used to identify the specific request to verify an MFA factor.
- A factor ID - identifier of the factor the user set up previously.
- A set of cookies with limited access.

From the code's perspective, this means: "You entered the correct login and password, but you still need to prove your identity." The user will receive a new set of cookies as soon as they provide the correct OTP code in the input field.

We also take into consideration how much time the user spends on the MFA input screen. After 60 seconds, the MFA challenge itself expires. This means that even if the OTP is still valid, the user must restart the login process, since the issued challenge ID is no longer recognized by the service.

MFA Management

The user can also manage their MFA factors. By navigating to `/settings/mfa-manage`, they will see their MFA factor ID. If they choose to delete it, they can press the delete button, after which they will be signed out. They can then log in again using only their email and password.

3.1.4 Future work on MFA

Usually, managing sensitive information such as MFA factors requires reauthentication. Currently, this is not implemented, but it is on the list of planned improvements.

CONCLUSIONS

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